

the RSS is intervening and imposing itself on the BJP.

A. The RSS never intervenes, only gives advice when asked.

Q. But you have said that the new leadership will be someone other than these four (Sushma Swaraj, Arun Jaitley, Venkaiah Naidu and Ananth Kumar).

A. Yes the new leadership will be someone other than these four. This is what I have been told. That is what has been agreed on and I believe the process has begun.

Q. You will get someone from outside Delhi between 50 and 55 years of age?

A. They will get someone from outside Delhi.

Q. In the last five-six years, several people who are media creations with no affiliation to the Sangh have come into prominence in the BJP. Has this lead to a dilution in ideology?

A. The Sangh is not against anyone, we don't look at anyone whether he is a swayamsevak or not.

Q. Are you worried about an image of corruption amongst the swayamsevaks who have joined the BJP?

A. Politics is a slippery ground but still we don't want to see one of our swayamsevaks slipping. We talk to them but it is up to the BJP to take action against them.

Q. The BJP is a visible face of the Sangh Parivar. Are you worried when you send workers to the party? They

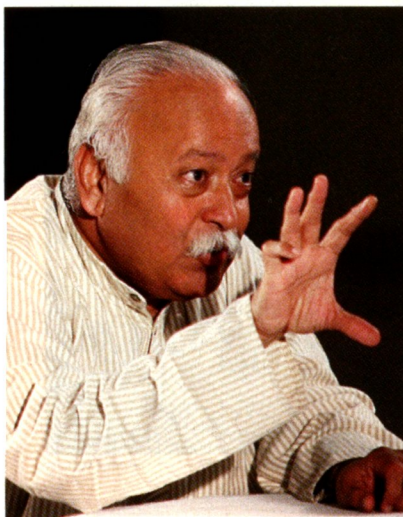
younger generation and the difference in 'a party with a difference' should be visible to all.

Q. There are some outfits that are not part of the Sangh, yet there is a perception that they belong—like the Sri Ram Sene of Karnataka... Pragya Thakur. Why don't you disassociate the RSS from them?

A. I have already said that I have nothing to do with the Sri Ram Sene. There is no such thing as Hindu terrorism. No Hindu will support terrorism.

Q. Yet you supported Pragya Thakur.

“Why should Modi apologise if he has done nothing wrong? Nobody talks about Godhra.”



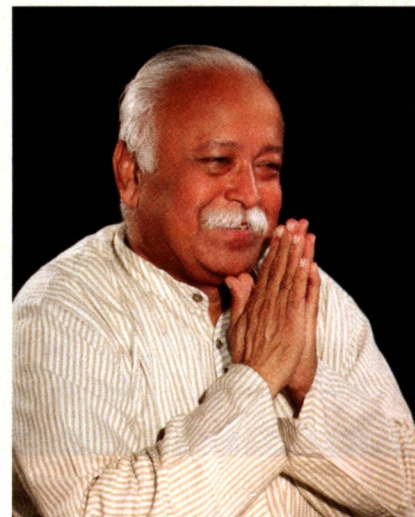
India. China has surrounded us by wooing our neighbouring countries from Maldives to Pakistan. We have to liberate our neighbours from the clutches of China.

Q. Have the Chinese defeated us at diplomacy?

A. Overtaken, not defeated. We can still do something.

Q. Regarding Pakistan, the BJP seems confused. What is the RSS view?

A. Pakistan exists on the premise of being anti-India. Pakistan needs to be given a decisive reply for all its mis-



“Chidambaram is saying a lot of good things. Let him deliver, only then will we praise him.”

also get affected by the personality cult and the individual becomes more important than the organisation.

A. Yes we are worried and we do talk to them about it.

Q. Would you prefer that the party is led by someone who believes in the RSS ideology?

A. Who will lead the party is something they will decide. What we want is someone who articulates our ideology, believes in teamwork, encourages the

A. No, all we said is that don't do a media trial. Let the courts decide.

Q. I saw a recent statement by the Sangh saying that P. Chidambaram is doing good work.

A. He is saying a lot of good things, but if he delivers on these, we will definitely praise him.

Q. Are we soft on China?

A. I have my doubts if the Government is alert on China. It has a well-defined strategy of encircling

chievous actions, we need another military victory over Pakistan. That is perhaps the only way by which we can prevent a 26/11 and terror attacks.

Q. Have we lost an opportunity to score a military victory?

A. When Parliament was attacked and then after 26/11. Our government failed us then. We lacked the will.

Q. Do you agree that a strong and stable Pakistan is good for India?

A. If Pakistan is mentally healthy and gives up anti-India sentiments only then it's good for India. ■

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